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Sunday Worship
8:30 & 11:00 AM

**Living Savior Lutheran Church
and Preschool
April 7, 2023
Good Friday
7:00 PM**



www.livingsaviorlutheran.org

**The Order of Tenebrae
April 7, 2023
7:00 P.M.**

The “*Officium Tenebrae*” is the Latin meaning “*Service of Darkness*” or “*Service of Shadows*”. This devotional and meditative service dates back to the 3rd or 4th century, and is observed on Good Friday in order to impress on the minds and hearts of believers the awful consequences of sin and the magnitude of the Savior’s sacrifice on the cross.

This evenings service focuses on the “shadows” that represent stages of the passion events. The Gospel readings trace the story of Christ’s journey to the cross, and are preceded by Old Testament prophecy. A series of twelve candles are extinguished during the service, as the sanctuary is gradually darkened, to represent the gathering darkness as Jesus moves closer to his crucifixion. As the candles are extinguished we sense the loneliness of Jesus as one by one, his disciples abandon him and flee.

One candle (*the Christ Candle*) remains burning throughout the service. When this candle is carried out, it symbolizes the death and burial of Jesus. But the candle returns, reminding us that even in the midst of death and darkness, the light of Christ prevails. The noise from the closing of the Bible at the conclusion of the service symbolizes the closing of Jesus’ tomb and reminds us that the Scriptures have been fulfilled.

In keeping with the solemnity of the day, there is no pre- service or post-service music. The service begins and ends in total silence. The congregation is requested to join in the singing of the hymns and in the whispering of the Lord’s Prayer, where indicated. The offering may be left in the basket as you leave this evening.

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Silent Processional

Invocation

P In the name of the Father, and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.

C Amen

P The Lord be with you.

C And also with you.

P Let us pray: Almighty God, graciously behold this your family, for whom our Lord Jesus Christ was willing to be betrayed, to be given into the hands of sinners, and to suffer death on the cross; who now lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C Amen.

Confession and Absolution

P Lord Jesus Christ, our great High Priest, when You came into this world of sin You were tested and tempted in all ways. Yet You did not sin, but became sin for us.

C Heavenly Father, we admit and confess that we have not lived according to your will. We have sinned against You in our thoughts, in our words, and in our actions. Have mercy on us, we pray, for the sake of our great High Priest, Jesus Christ.

P The death of Christ was on your behalf. At the command of Jesus Christ I forgive you all your sins in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.

C Amen.

THE SERVICE OF SHADOWS

I. The Shadow of Betrayal

Psalm 41:5-9

(candle extinguished)

Matthew 26:20-25

✠ **The Lord's Prayer** (*Whispered*)

II. The Shadow of Agony

Psalm 88:1-9

(candle extinguished)

Luke 22:39-44

Hymn

"Come to Calvary's Holy Mountain" # 435



1 Come to Cal - v'ry's ho - ly moun - tain, Sin - ners, ru - ined
2 Come in pov - er - ty and mean - ness, Come de - filed, with -
3 Come in sor - row and con - tri - tion, Wound - ed, im - po -
4 They that drink shall live for - ev - er; 'Tis a soul - re -



by the fall; Here a pure and heal - ing foun - tain
out, with - in; From in - fec - tion and un - clean - ness,
tent, and blind; Here the guilt - y, free re - mis - sion,
new - ing flood. God is faith - ful; God will nev - er



Flows for you, for me, for all, In a full, per -
From the lep - ro - sy of sin, Wash your robes and
Here the trou - bled, peace may find. Health this foun - tain
Break His cov - e - nant of blood, Signed when our Re -



pet - ual tide, O - pened when our Sav - ior died.
make them white; Ye shall walk with God in light.
will re - store; They that drink shall thirst no more.
deem - er died, Sealed when He was glo - ri - fied.

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III. The Shadow of Loneliness

Psalm 42:3-11

(candle extinguished)

Matthew 26:40-46

IV. The Shadow of Desertion

Lamentations 1:16-21a
(candle extinguished)
Matthew 26:48-49, 55-56

Hymn **“My Song Is Love Unknown” # 430**

1 My song is love un - known, My Sav - ior's love to
2 He came from His blest throne Sal - va - tion to be -
4 Why, what hath my Lord done? What makes this rage and
5 They rise and needs will have My dear Lord made a -

me, Love to the love - less shown That they might love - ly
stow; But men made strange, and none The longed - for Christ would
spite? He made the lame to run, He gave the blind their
way; A mur - der - er they save, The Prince of Life they

be. Oh, who am I That for my sake
know. But, oh, my friend, My friend in - deed,
sight. Sweet in - ju - ries! Yet they at these
slay. Yet cheer - ful He To suf - f'ring goes

My Lord should take Frail flesh and die?
Who at my need His life did spend!
Them - selves dis - please And 'gainst Him rise.
That He His foes From thence might free.

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V. The Shadow of Arrest

Psalms 2:1-6
(candle extinguished)
Mark 14:45-46

Hymn **“Stricken, Smitten, and Afflicted” # 451**

1 Strick - en, smit - ten, and af - flict - ed, See Him dy - ing on the
2 Tell me, ye who hear Him groan - ing, Was there ev - er grief like
3 Ye who think of sin but light - ly Nor sup - pose the e - vil
4 Here we have a firm foun - da - tion, Here the ref - uge of the

tree! 'Tis the Christ, by man re - ject - ed; Yes, my
His? Friends through fear His cause dis - own - ing, Foes in -
great Here may view its na - ture right - ly, Here its
lost: Christ, the Rock of our sal - va - tion, Is the

soul, 'tis He, 'tis He! 'Tis the long - ex - spect - ed
sult - ing His dis - tress; Man - y hands were raised to
guilt may es - ti - mate. Mark the sac - ri - fice ap -
name of which we boast; Lamb of God, for sin - ners

Proph - et, Da - vid's Son, yet Da - vid's Lord; Proofs I
wound Him, None would in - ter - vene to save; But the
point - ed, See who bears the aw - ful load; 'Tis the
wound - ed, Sac - ri - fice to can - cel guilt! None shall

see suf - fi - cient of it: 'Tis the true and faith - ful Word.
deep - est stroke that pierced Him Was the stroke that jus - tice gave.
Word, the Lord's a - noint - ed, Son of Man and Son of God.
ev - er be con - found - ed Who on Him their hope have built.

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VI. The Shadow of Denial

Lamenations 2:7-8, 13-15

(candle extinguished)

Luke 22:54-62

VII. The Shadow of Accusation

Psalm 27:7-12

(candle extinguished)

Matthew 26:59-66

✱ The Lord’s Prayer (*Whispered*)

VIII. The Shadow of Mockery

Psalm 22:14-19

(candle extinguished)

Matthew 27:27-30

IX. The Shadow of Crucifixion

Isaiah 53:1-7

(candle extinguished)

Matthew 27:31-43

X. The Shadow of Death

Zephaniah 1:14-18

(candle extinguished)

Luke 23:44-49

Hymn

“When I Survey the Wondrous Cross” # 425



1 When I sur - vey the won - drous cross On which the
2 For - bid it, Lord, that I should boast Save in the
3 See, from His head, His hands, His feet Sor - row and
4 Were the whole realm of na - ture mine, That were a



Prince of Glo - ry died, My rich - est gain I
death of Christ, my God; All the vain things that
love flow min - gled down! Did e'er such love and
trib - ute far too small; Love so a - maz - ing,



count but loss And pour con - tempt on all my pride.
charm me most, I sac - ri - fice them to His blood.
sor - row meet Or thorns com - pose so rich a crown?
so di - vine, De - mands my soul, my life, my all!

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XI. The Shadow of Burial

Isaiah 53:9-12

(candle extinguished)

John 19:38-42

Psalm 51:1-3

(candle extinguished)

P Be merciful to me, O God, because of your constant love, because of your great mercy wipe away my sins! I recognize my faults; I am always conscious of my sins.

I have been evil from the day I was born; from the time I was conceived, I have been sinful. Remove my sin, and I will be clean; wash me, and I will be whiter than snow.

Close your eyes to my sins and wipe out all my evil. Do not banish me from your presence; do not take your Holy Spirit away from me. Then I will teach sinners your commands, and they will turn back to You. Help me to speak, Lord, and I will praise you. My sacrifice is a humble spirit, O God; you will not reject a humble and repentant heart.

He was humble and walked the path of obedience to death --- even death on a cross.

Exit the Christ candle

✠ **The Lord's Prayer** (*Whispered*)

Closing of the Bible

Return of the Christ candle

Benediction

(Worshippers may leave in silence)



Easter Sunday

8:30 am Holy Communion

10:00 Easter Egg Hunt

11:00 am Holy Communion